



Swiss Institutional · Scientific Authority

**The modern cigar world
has evolved.
Your standards should too.**

Cigar Sommelier Education & Certification
pathways build on our proprietary
Cigar Peak-Flavor System®

cigarsommelierinstitute.com

From Intuition To Calibrated Performance

As the global market expands beyond classic Cuban references, professionals and aficionados face an unprecedented diversity of blends, constructions and flavor profiles. ICSI provides a rigorous, discreet system to decode this complexity, translating blend structure into precise smoking conditions and repeatable peak-flavor performance.

ICSI is the first globally to offer certification courses that include sensory science, quantification of flavor and aroma, data-driven cigar classification, and digital tools including applications, analytics and guided tasting systems. ICSI applies the ISO/IEC 17024 Quality Systems framework.

Three Audiences, Three Pathways

Professionals

For aspiring cigar professionals. Build a career grounded in precision, structure and credibility, with a rigorous understanding of cigar construction, combustion dynamics, humidity behavior and flavor evolution. Preparing candidates for premium lounges, retail and luxury hospitality.

Business

For retailers, lounges and hospitality groups. Modernise your cigar offering through implementation and certification of the Cigar Peak-Flavor System®, to standardise service, optimise performance, strengthen loyalty and grow cigar sales with confidence.

Private Mastery

For aficionados and collectors. An advanced private pathway for a more precise understanding of calibration, ageing, performance staging and peak-flavor delivery across a wider range of blends.

Certification Pathways

Four tailored pathways for professional development, industry modernisation and advanced personal optimisation.



ICSI LEVEL I

Aficionado Master Class (AMC)

Ideal for both enthusiasts and elite aficionados. Learn how to truly appreciate cigars by removing guesswork. Achieve repeatable peak-flavor, pair like a pro and grow your collection confidently.

Humidor Support: a full diagnostic and calibration of your humidor to your blends' peak-flavor conditions.

199 Euros



ICSI LEVEL II

Certified Cigar Sommelier Course (CCS)

The professional standard for cigar service. Build precision cigar diagnostics, flavor dynamics and scientific pairing accuracy.

399 Euros



ICSI LEVEL III

Advanced Cigar Sommelier Course (ACS)

Predictive modelling and advanced diagnostics. Increase expertise across all blends, vintages, settling period and pairing science.

299 Euros



ICSI LEVEL IV

Cigar Master Sommelier Certification

Final step in the journey. Requires at least 2 years of professional experience and references. Become an ICSI ambassador, CPFS implementation expert and master class teacher.

Offered/Funded by ICSI

Decoding Cigars - by ICSI

Decoding and mastering the complex world of new cigar blends, with Anthony Azar, Founder of ICSI. Educated at Imperial College London with a Master of Engineering in Thermodynamics & Combustion Science, and more than three decades with cigars, Anthony guides participants through a practical, structured approach to cigar selection and performance, moving beyond rules of thumb into a predictive framework.



Presented at InterTabac 2026 in Dortmund as an ICSI educational masterclass, Decoding Cigars introduced participants to a structured, predictive approach to cigar selection and performance.

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Powered by the scientific Cigar Peak-Flavor System®

EXPLORE OUR
LEARNING PATHWAYS



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